

Board Members & Trainers

BOARD MEMBERS

Dr. Joanes Atela

Founder & Executive Director, ARIN

Dr. Joanes Atela is a leading African scientist and institution builder with over 15 years of experience in research, climate policy, and technical advisory work. As Founder and Executive Director of ARIN, he leads a network of over 200 researchers and policymakers across 36 African countries. Formerly Director of Partnerships and Impact at the African Centre for Technology Studies (ACTS), he is Lead Expert for the African Union Green Innovation Framework and serves on the Strategic Advisory Group of UKRI. He holds a PhD in Environment and Development from the University of Leeds, an MSc in Natural Resource Management from Bonn University (First Class), and a BSc from Maseno University (First Class Honours). He has over 1,000 Google Scholar citations and has been recognised with the Young Scientist Award by the European Meteorological Society.

Prof. Idil Boran

Professor of Philosophy, York University, Canada

Prof. Idil Boran is a Full Professor in the Department of Philosophy at York University, Toronto, specialising in political philosophy, applied ethics, and global climate governance. She has participated as an accredited observer in UN Climate Change conferences since 2012, organising and speaking at COP side events. She is the author of *Political Theory and Global Climate Action: Recasting the Public Sphere* (Routledge, 2019) and an associated researcher with the German Development Institute (DIE). Her work bridges academic philosophy and international climate policy, with a particular focus on equity, justice, and the role of non-state actors in the global climate regime.

Dr. J.P. Ochieng'Odero

Scientist & Research Systems Specialist

Dr. J.P.R. Ochieng'-Odero is a scientist with a keen interest in science, technology, and innovation in economic development, and the role of evidence in informing African policy and practice. He holds a PhD in Zoology (Entomology) from the University of Auckland and has led major research programmes, including as Team Leader of FCDO's Research and Innovation Systems for Africa (RISA) and the East Africa Research Fund (EARF). He is a Member of the Kenya National Academy of Sciences, the African Scientific Advisory Board of The African Academy of Sciences, and has consulted for the World Bank on research strategy for the PASET-RSIF fund. He is widely regarded as a champion for the use of research evidence to drive development in Africa.

Prof. Dawn Bazley

University Professor of Biology, York University, Canada

Prof. Dawn Bazley is a University Professor and Professor of Biology at York University's Faculty of Science, where she has been a faculty member since 1990. She directed York's Institute for Research and Innovation in Sustainability for seven years and received the university's Sustainability Leadership Award and the title of University Professor in 2017. Her research spans ecology, herbivory, invasive species, climate change, and science policy. She holds a doctorate in Zoology from Oxford University and has published over 70 academic works resulting in more than 2,000 citations. She is a recipient of the Ontario Minister of Colleges and Universities' Award of Excellence and the Royal Canadian Institute for Science's Sandford Fleming Medal for science communication.

Prof. George Krhoda

Professor of Geography & Environmental Studies, University of Nairobi

Prof. George Okoye Krhoda is a Professor of Geography and Environmental Studies at the University of Nairobi, specialising in hydrology, water resources management, and environmental governance. He holds a PhD in River Hydraulics and Water Resources Planning and was formerly Permanent Secretary of Kenya's Ministry of Environment and Natural Resources and Ministry of Water and Irrigation, as well as Dean of the Faculty of Social Sciences at the University of Nairobi. He is the Managing Director of REDPLAN Consultants Ltd. and has consulted for the World Bank,

UNDP, UNICEF, UNEP, and the African Centre for Technology Studies. He was awarded the Chief of the Order of the Burning Spear (CBS) for transformative leadership in Kenya's water sector reforms.

TRAINERS

Dr. Francis Oloo

GIS & Remote Sensing Researcher | Lead Coordinator, Publishing Academy

Dr. Francis Oloo (Dr. rer. nat) is an expert in Geographic Information Science with over a decade of experience applying GIS and Remote Sensing to address socio-ecological vulnerabilities in Africa. He holds a PhD in Geographic Information Science from the University of Salzburg and is currently a Lecturer and Researcher in Earth Observation, Water and Food Security at the Technical University of Kenya, as well as an Adjunct Lecturer in Spatial Data Science at Strathmore University. He is the co-founder and lead researcher at GeoPsy Research and has worked with institutions including CIMMYT, KEMRI/Wellcome Trust, and the World Agroforestry Centre. Dr. Oloo is also passionate about effective science communication and the promotion of open geospatial tools across Africa. At ARIN, he serves as AI for Climate Resilience programme lead.

Dr. Eurallyah Akinyi

Advocate, Economist & Policy Specialist

Dr. Eurallyah Akinyi is an Advocate of the High Court of Kenya and an economist working at the intersection of sustainable development, climate finance, energy transition, trade and investment, and public policy. She builds coalitions across government, civil society, and the private sector and has published widely on international trade and investment law, climate change, sovereign debt, global governance, artificial intelligence, and business and human rights.

Dr. Maureen Ngesa

Academic Writing & Research Capacity Specialist

Dr. Maureen Ngesa is a behavioural systems and programme design leader with a background in clinical psychology and mental health and psychosocial support (MHPSS), working across Kenya and East Africa. She specialises in translating evidence, stakeholder insights, and policy priorities into scalable implementation systems, including programme design, MEL frameworks, and delivery structures. Her expertise in behavioural science, systems thinking, and multi-stakeholder engagement brings a rigorous, evidence-grounded lens to research communication, knowledge translation, and capacity building, skills directly applicable to supporting African scholars in producing and disseminating high-quality, policy-relevant research.

Dr. Fiona Ngarachu

Research Methods & Policy Communication Specialist

Dr. Fiona Ngarachu is an Assistant Professor at the United States International University Africa (USIU-A) and a political scientist with a PhD from the University of Southampton and a Master's in Political Research from the University of Strathclyde, Scotland. With five years of university teaching experience in research methods, political science, and social science at undergraduate and postgraduate levels, she brings a strong grounding in curriculum development, training and facilitation, and research capacity building, all central to the Publishing Academy's mission. Her applied development research across HIV prevention, refugee resettlement, and water security gives her a keen understanding of translating evidence into policy-relevant outputs. As co-founder of the African Youth Dialogues, an online platform engaging youth from 17 African countries, she also brings demonstrated experience in building knowledge-sharing communities across the continent, directly aligned with the Academy's goal of strengthening Africa's research-to-impact pipeline.

COORDINATOR

Florence Onyango

Senior Manager, Science Communications

Florence Onyango is Senior Manager of Science Communications at the Africa Research and Impact Network (ARIN), where she oversees editorial strategy, heads ARIN Press, and leads policy engagement across the organisation's research programmes. An editor of technical papers, research reports, and policy briefs, she has also contributed opinion pieces to Nation Africa, The Standard, and Devex. She holds an MSc in Climate Change Adaptation (University of Nairobi), a BSc in Communication (Moi University), and is an IRCA-certified ISO 9001 Lead Auditor.